

Courses most in demand



Golden Gate University and IIM Kozhikode, etc.

The courses on offer are varied—from management-related ones (especially executive MBAs) to data science, full-stack software developer, digital marketing, artificial intelligence (Generative AI) and machine learning, business analytics (project management and leadership programmes), and more. Typically, the duration of the diploma and certificate courses these platforms offer ranges from a few weeks to three years. While anyone who is a graduate can enrol in these courses, most people who go in for these are usually already a part of the workforce.

Mayank Kumar, Co-founder and MD of upGrad, says millennials are embracing these courses to distinguish themselves from the masses. “For instance, someone who has done engineering will not stand out in a crowd versus someone who has done engineering plus a data analytics course,” he says, adding that millennials prefer to enrol in an online course offered by a reputed university over a regular one at a Tier II or III college.

Do note that while the global MBA programmes are accredited by the World Education Services, a credential evaluation services company, they may not be recognised by accreditation agencies in India. The partnerships with the IIMs, meanwhile, are for postgraduate

programmes and are not full-time MBAs.

Still, the workforce has been opting for such courses. Experts say in developing economies such as India and Brazil, there is an eagerness among a significant part of the workforce to invest in upskilling. This stems from the realisation that there can be a substantial return on investment (ROI) through upskilling. Akshay Munjal, Founder and CEO of Hero Vired, says a chunk of the Indian population is in its early 20s. “After doing a job or two they realise they want to upskill [themselves],” he says, adding that the upskilling industry has leveraged the gaps in the traditional universities.

In India, courses on data science, digital marketing and management have the highest demand followed by technology (artificial intelligence, cloud, robotics, cybersecurity), say industry watchers. “Most of the demand is for tech upskilling courses,” says Mohan Lakhamraju, Founder and CEO of Great Learning, which was acquired by BYJU’S in 2021. While management programmes make up a staggering 85 per cent of the online executive courses on offer, the number of tech-oriented courses is steadily rising because of massive demand. Lakhamraju says the demand for these courses is a reflection of India’s